MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused primarily on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Hands-on experience maintaining GitLab CI for three product teams, building short-lived Kubernetes test environments with Helm, and improving pipeline speed and reliability. Additional personal experience provisioning Hetzner VPS infrastructure with Terraform and running a GitOps-managed k3s homelab. Transitioning toward DevOps and platform engineering, with hands-on experience in CI/CD infrastructure, Kubernetes-based test environments, observability, and personal Terraform-managed infrastructure.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal Hetzner VPS project; infrastructure provisioning), Argo CD, AWS: EC2 and S3 basics (free-tier learning)
Containers & platforms: Kubernetes (namespace-level access; Helm deployments to shared cluster), k3s
Monitoring & logging: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki
Operating systems & networking: Linux, Traefik, cert-manager, TLS certificate management
Programming & scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL
Testing & data: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman, PostgreSQL
Other: Git, Ansible (basic)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, as well as artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end testing; monthly CI runner costs decreased by about 30%.
- Built short-lived test environments for merge requests using Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. The platform team operates the cluster; my access is at namespace level.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Wrote an internal guide to the CI system used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Ran a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster with applications deployed from a Git repository using

Argo CD.

- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki, with Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform in a personal project; deployed and operated applications on a three-node Raspberry Pi k3s cluster using Argo CD.
- Technologies: k3s, Argo CD, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Terraform, Ansible (basic).

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023–2024

- Built a GitLab CI workflow that deploys a short-lived environment for each merge request, including the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, using Helm on a shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Configured automatic environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams use the environments for feature review and end-to-end testing.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team; the dashboards helped teams identify and address recurring failures.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA): studying; exam scheduled for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)